Muzhi Liu

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Education

Ph.D. in Political Science, Columbia University — expected May 2028
Concurrent M.A. in Statistics, Columbia University — expected May 2027

Ph.D. coursework in the Departments of Mathematics and Statistics: Analysis, Probability, and Statistical Inference sequences; Probabilistic Models and Machine Learning.

Additional coursework: Causal Inference, Field Experiments, Bayesian Statistics, Stochastic Processes, Game Theory, Optimization, Differential Equations.

B.A. in Political Science, *magna cum laude*, Emory University, Atlanta, GA — May 2023

Research Interests

Causal Inference in Political Economy; AI Evaluation; LLM-Based Measurement

Methods and Skills

Causal inference; Experiments; Text-as-data/NLP; Machine Learning; LLM-based measurement; Mathematical modeling and analysis

Tools: R, Python, Stan, LaTeX, Git, SQL, Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific

Revise and Resubmit

1. "Campaign Giving Under Employment Threat: Federal Employees and the DOGE Workforce Reduction." [*Revise and resubmit at* ***Political Behavior***]
2. "When Group Issues and Core Issues Collide: Evidence from Tailored Conjoint Experiments on Latino Voters" (with Yamil Velez). [*Revise and resubmit at* ***Political Behavior***]

Manuscripts Under Review

1. "Borrowed Battlegrounds: The Formation and Reorganization of Foreign-Language Event-Publics around U.S. Political Violence." [*Submitted*]
2. "Estimand-First Comparative Text Analysis: Measuring Discourse Change Across Co-Exposed Platforms." [*Under review*]
3. "Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting" (with John B. Holbein and Xuan Li). [*Under review*]

Ongoing Projects

1. "Buying American Abroad: Political Identity and Consumer Choice" (with Donald P. Green).
2. "Claiming Corporate Success: Economic Exposure and Support for the Incumbent Party." [*Draft in Progress*]
3. "Better Questions for the Better Trained: LLM Memory and Unequal Research Advice." [*Working paper*]
4. "The Unequal Collapse of Disciplinary Barriers: Generative AI and the Reallocation of Scientific Talent" (with Gary Ziwen Zu).
5. "Primary Election and Intra-Party Factions" (with Shigeo Hirano and Sam Frederick).

Grants and Awards

IHS Mentorship Grant, Institute for Humane Studies ($8,000) — Summer 2026
American Political Science Association, Spring Centennial Research Grant ($2,500) — Spring 2026
Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Student Seed Grant ($1,000) — Fall 2025
First Place, Young Public Opinion Scholar Competition, NY/PA–NJ AAPOR ($1,000) — Summer 2025

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA) Sep. 2026

Li, X.; **Liu, M.** "Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting."

Liu, M. "Borrowed Battlegrounds: The Formation and Reorganization of Foreign-Language Event-Publics around U.S. Political Violence."

Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference May 2026

Li, X.; **Liu, M.** "Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting."

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA) Apr. 2026

Liu, M. "Electoral Spectators: The 2024 U.S. Presidential Election and Online Political Discourse in China."

American Association for Public Opinion Research Annual Conference (AAPOR) May 2025

Velez, Y.; **Liu, M.** "In Their Own Words: A Tailored Approach to Measuring Politicized Group Attachments."

Seminar Presentations

Political Science Graduate Student Seminar, Columbia University 2026

Columbia–NYU Graduate Student Seminar in Political Science 2026

American Politics Graduate Student Seminar, Columbia University 2025–2026

Comparative Politics Seminar, Columbia University 2025

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University 2024–2026

Graduate courses: Quantitative Methods IV: Advanced Statistical Modeling (Spring 2026); Quantitative Methods III: Field Experiments (Fall 2025); Math and Statistics in Political Science (Spring 2024).

Undergraduate courses: Experiments (Fall 2026); Introduction to American Politics and Government (Summer 2024; Spring 2025).

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Columbia University 2023–2024

Supervisors: Robert Shapiro and Alan Yang. Public opinion and polarization projects; cleaned and merged survey datasets; implemented regression and robustness pipelines in R; produced publication-ready figures and tables.

Research Assistant, Emory University 2021–2023

Supervisors: Kiela Crabtree, Zachary Peskowitz, and Kevin Sparrow. Research on political violence and minority politics; assembled datasets from public sources; conducted literature synthesis; supported survey/conjoint design and analysis; prepared replication-ready code and documentation.

Academic Service

Editorial Assistant, *Political Science Quarterly* Mar. 2024–Spring 2026

Linkage Chair, Political Science Graduate Student Council, Columbia University Jun. 2024–May 2025

Member, Student Advisory Board, Emory University Sep. 2021–May 2023

Professional Experience

Community Engagement Intern, International Rescue Committee, Atlanta, GA Jun. 2023–Sep. 2023

Academic Consultant and Instructor, Yuan Foundation, Washington, DC May 2023–Aug. 2023

Research Assistant, Ashoka, Remote Jan. 2023–Apr. 2023